



Jaku Templates

First off, let me thank you for buying and supporting my work! If you, however, came across this theme for free (didn't pay), please consider making a [donation](#). I work really hard on this stuff!

The Twin Templates

These files are here so you can make your icons and continue to expand Jaku. Please read this guide to ensure you create the best icons you can. With but only a few tips, you can ensure you meet the baseline standards so your work fits in beautifully with the rest of the Jaku icons, no matter your skill level. So let's get started.

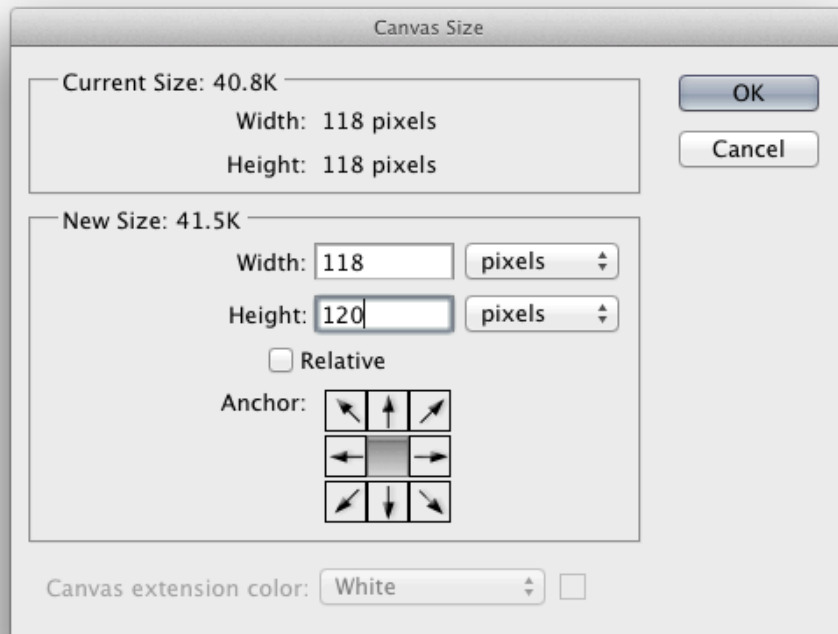
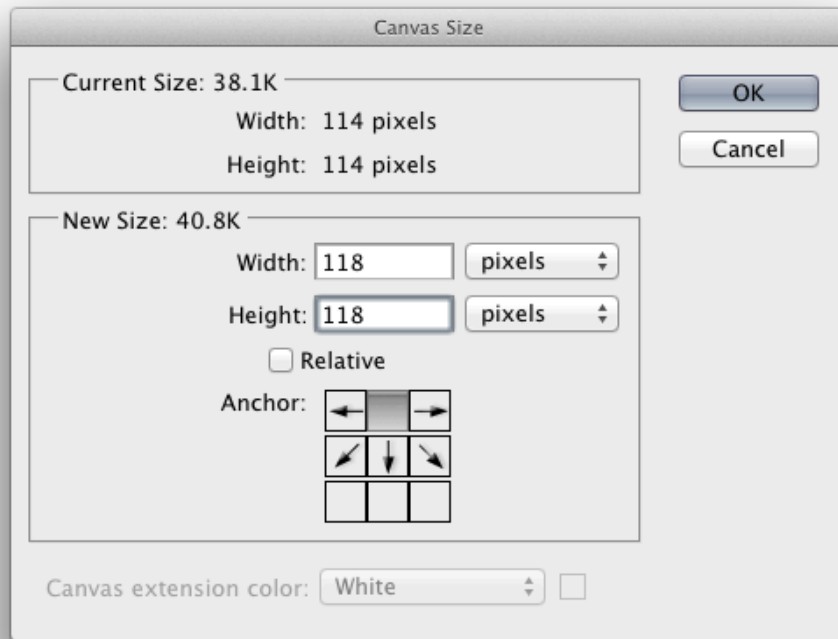
First off, let me explain the two folders. The Default Apps + Cydia (118px x 120px) template is to be used for any icon that you've installed through Cydia (Bite SMS, SBSettings, etc.) or one that already comes on the device the moment you unbox it (iTunes, Mail, Reminders, etc.). The template found in the App Store folder (114px x 114px) is to be used for any app you bought through the official Apple App Store. Most people mix these up, or mix and match the two. *Don't do this!* If you use the larger template on theming the apps you have installed through the App Store, they'll look smaller on your device (and ugly). This is because iOS will shrink them from the 118x120px dimension to the 114x114px. If you do the opposite, the icons will look bigger, and that's because iOS will enlarge them, taking the 114x114px to 118x120px. *Using the right template is very important.*

Now that you know about the two sizes, what happens if you want to take, say the icon I made for the iTunes, and use it for something you downloaded from the App Store (so you're moving from a 118x120px icon to a 114x114px)? Well, you *can't* just resize them blindly. You have to resize them using the following method:

1. Open the icon up in Photoshop.

2. Go to Image > Canvas Size...

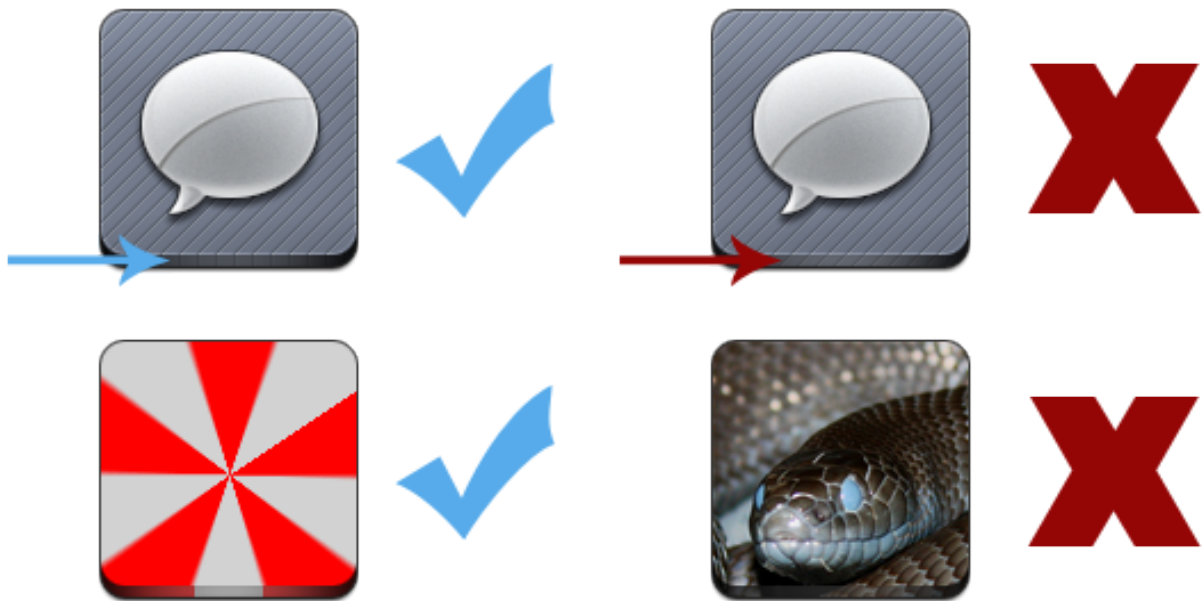
Then you'll have to do two passes (once, you hit OK the first time, just select Canvas Size again and fill in the values of the second box). They are as follows:



Best Practices

Now that you understand the basics, let's talk about best practices. The hard part about making icons is the bottom bevel. That gets almost everyone (and that's what prompted me to do this guide). Let me explain how the bevel works, semantically (or how you should think about the bevel in your head).

The bevel is the side of the icon, not a continuation of the face. Some of you may go, "huh?" Let me show you. Look at the icons on the left:



Notice how it looks like you cut into the icon, like you would cut a piece of multilayered cake? That's what I mean when I say it's the "side of the icon." Try to imagine it this way: if you bite into a Twinky (mmmm, Twinky...), you'll see the filling. That's the bevel. It should "cut into" your icon:



Using these “best practices,” you should be able to make quality icons no matter your Photoshop skill level. Happy theming!

In loving memory of Steve Jobs. 1955-2011.